

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday March 19, 2020

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors
Meeting #25, March 19, 2020

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom) beginning at 16:00 UTC, due to technical difficulties the meeting was not started until 16:20 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (11/11): Richard Carlsson, Francesco Cesarini, Benoît Chesneau, Maxim Fedorov, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Kenneth Lundin, Miriam Pena Villanueva, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, José Valim, and Alistair Woodman. Note: Kenneth joined during #3 (treasury update), José joined during #4 (board election).

Agenda Items

1. Vote of the minutes of the previous meeting.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #24 held on February 20, 2020. Unanimously approved..

2. Intermediate actions:

1. Tax season is upon us, we will get help from the Foundation Group (tax deadline may be delayed given the current circumstances)
2. Since the last meeting we decided to postpone the voting period by a week (the voting period will now be March 20 - 27).
3. Treasury update: We have \$168K in the bank. Since last meeting we have received payment from Ericsson, and a physical check from our new sponsor NineFX. Sebastian will resend the invoice to TI Tokyo. Membership update: we have 366 basic members, 88 annual supporting members, and 7 lifetime members.
4. Annual board election: Peer and Fred presented the Wildapricot voting poll that will be used for the upcoming board election. The voting will be open between Friday March 20, and Friday March 27. All supporting, board, fellow, lifetime, and “managing and contributing” (need to claim) members get one vote for each four

positions that are open. Next board meeting will be for all old members and any potential new members, where any old board member that did not get re-elected will participate in hand over.

5. Alistair presented insurance offer for board insurance, at around \$2300/year (possibly plus 10% commission) for the whole board. It was agreed that Alistair should proceed.
6. José presented stipend proposal, requesting \$2100 for a project to improve ExDoc (full proposal included at the end of these minutes).

RESOLVED, that Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approves the request for \$2100 for the proposed project to improve ExDoc.

7. Any other business

1. Francesco informed us of the situation with Erlang Central. Erlang Solutions does not have enough resources to keep it running and there are not enough volunteers to pick it up. It will stay up for at most two more months, unless someone can take over.
 2. Peer retracted his previous proposal regarding a job board / community manager.
8. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 17:03 UTC.

Dated March 19, 2020

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Attachments:

1. Stipend Proposal from José Valim

Purpose

This stipend would fund 60 hours of design work on ExDoc, an HTML/EPUB documentation generator.

The Documentation WG is working towards the adoption of EEP 48 across BEAM languages. As more languages adopt EEP 48, it means tools that print, format, and emit documentation can work consistently across languages.

Lately a lot of progress has been made so the Erlang/OTP docs and EDoc projects adopt EEP 48. This allows developers, for instance, to access the documentation of a module or function directly in the shell, regardless of how the documentation was written. We have also built a proof of concept of using ExDoc to format Erlang/OTP docs: http://wojtekmach.pl/otp_docs/stdlib/array.html

Our goal is to continue improving the tooling and make ExDoc the default HTML/EPUB generator for BEAM languages. A lot of the work is being done under the hood but, in order to support multiple languages, we will need to make design improvements to ExDoc, which we need external help for and is the goal of this stipend request.

There are two main fronts for our efforts:

1. Improving the menu/sidebar. The menu/sidebar has historically been a source of complaints and confusion due to its unnatural source of navigation. We want to address its usability issues as we make ExDoc the default tool for the BEAM
2. Add new design elements to the generated docs. For example, Erlang documentation has "Warning" / "Caution" / "Note" panes that are not currently supported by ExDoc. We need to add these design elements and others that may come along the way.

Budget and recipient

We request a budget of \$2100 for 60 hours of work. Approximately 40 hours will be used to improve the menu/sidebar, the remaining 20 hours will be used to add new design elements and to fulfill other requests and design needs that may arise in the future.

The recipient of the stipend will be Przemek Krowiński, who developed the autocompletion and tooltips features available on ExDoc. He also contributes actively to ExDoc, so he is familiar with the codebase.

Other considerations

This stipend does not include:

- * Work to be done on EDoc to make it compatible with EEP 48 and integrate with ExDoc
- * Design work to be done on the EPUB toolchain of ExDoc

We list those two elements separately because we may request budgets for these tasks in the future.

Beneficiaries

This development will benefit the whole BEAM community as we move towards making ExDoc a HTML/EPUB generation tool for the whole Erlang Ecosystem.

Deliverables / report

The deliverable will be a new ExDoc menu/sidebar and improved design elements for integration with Erlang/OTP and EDoc. Once the work has been completed, we will submit a quick report with the relevant PRs and links to the new design elements being used in projects.

Author

This stipend request was authored by José Valim, chair of the Documentation WG.